

H4: Prodding societies in ecology and evolution towards greater equity of their membership fee structures: a meta-research protocol

by Marija Purgar & Losia (Malgorzata) Lagisz

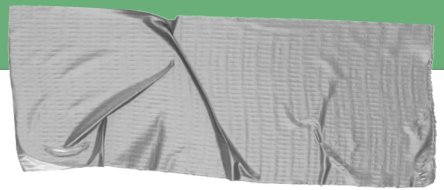
14 October 2026, 01:00-02:55 UTC

Hello!



Little plan for this hackathon:

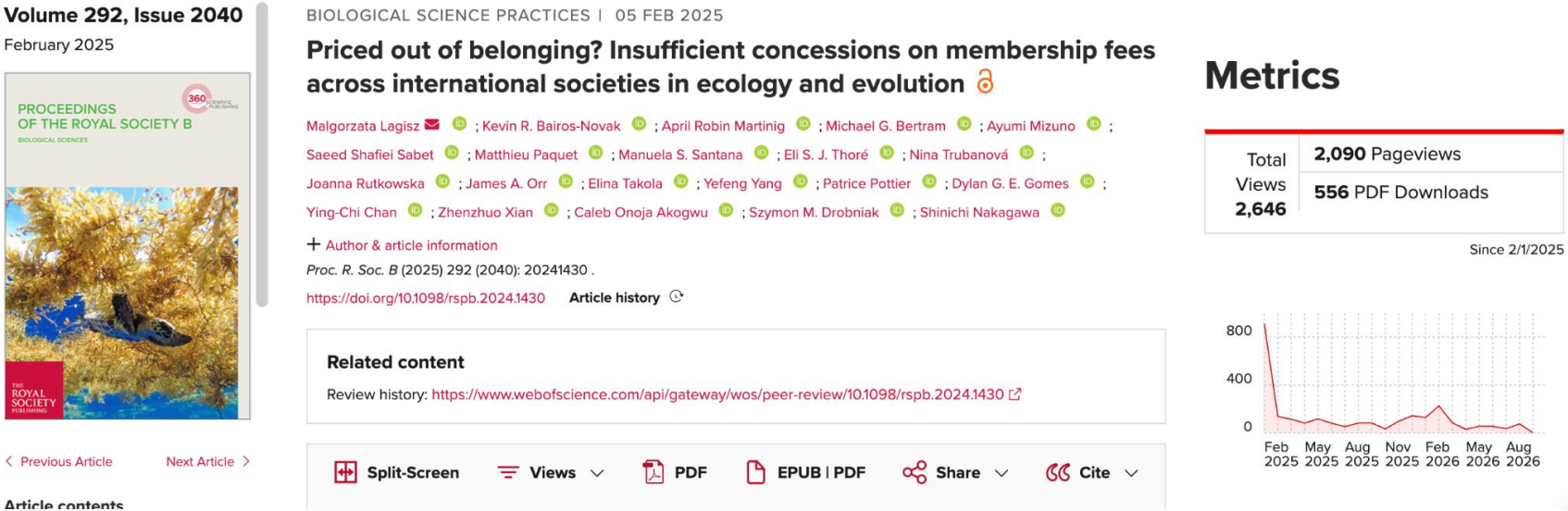
- SORTEE Code of Conduct applies
- Project purpose
- Plan for today
- Questions & discussion



Background

➔ Survey of society member fees in EcoEvo

Lagisz et al. (2025) *Priced out of belonging? Insufficient concessions on membership fees across international societies in ecology and evolution*, Proc. R. Soc. B 292: 20241430 (doi:10.1098/rspb.2024.1430)



Volume 292, Issue 2040
February 2025

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BIOLOGICAL SCIENCE PRACTICES | 05 FEB 2025

Priced out of belonging? Insufficient concessions on membership fees across international societies in ecology and evolution

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+ Author & article information

Proc. R. Soc. B (2025) 292 (2040): 20241430 .

https://doi.org/10.1098/rspb.2024.1430 **Article history**

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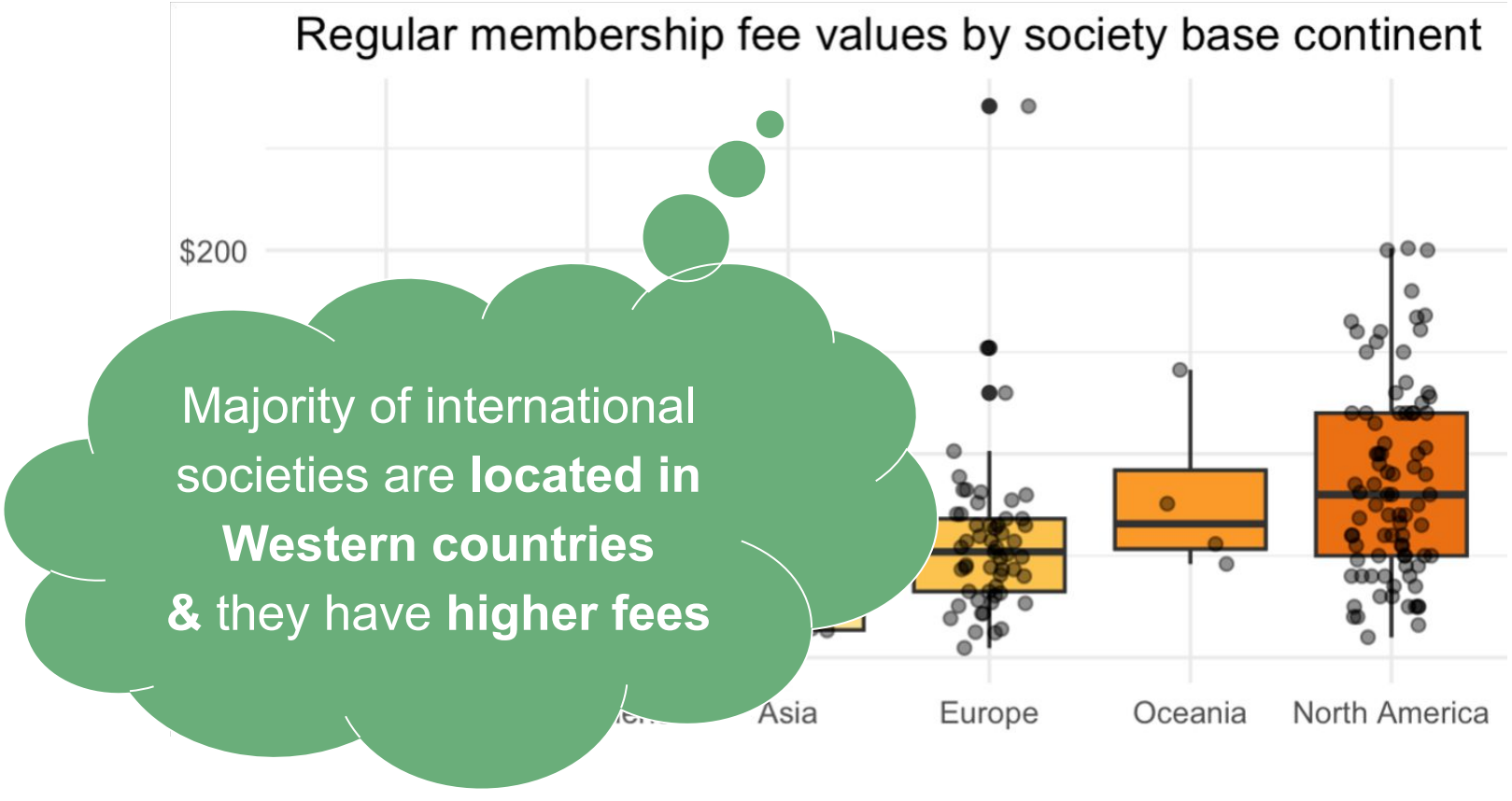
Since 2/1/2025

➔ **Membership fees of learned societies in EcoEvo (Lagisz et al., 2025):** doi:10.1098/rspb.2024.1430

43% had discounts or waivers for members from **low-income** countries

Few had **discounts for postdocs** and other groups

➔ **Membership fees of learned societies in EcoEvo (Lagisz et al., 2025):** doi:10.1098/rspb.2024.1430



What we did next

STEP 1

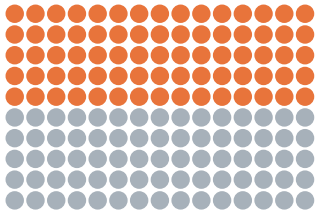
Ethics approved

UNSW Sydney Human Research Ethics Committee

iRECS8137

STEP 2

Randomised



75 prodding **75** control

STEP 3

Tailored report

Society-specific assessment built from baseline data with an R template

STEP 4

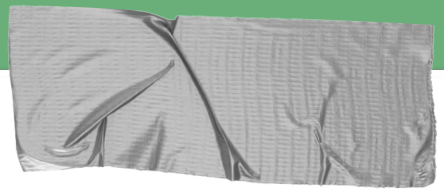
Prodding email

Sent individually by ML, with report + 8 recommendations

3 May 2025

EACH REPORT (EMAIL) INCLUDED

- Request to pass to council
- Link to baseline paper
- Your society's results
- 8 tips for fairer fees
- Invitation to ask questions
- Ethics & complaints contacts

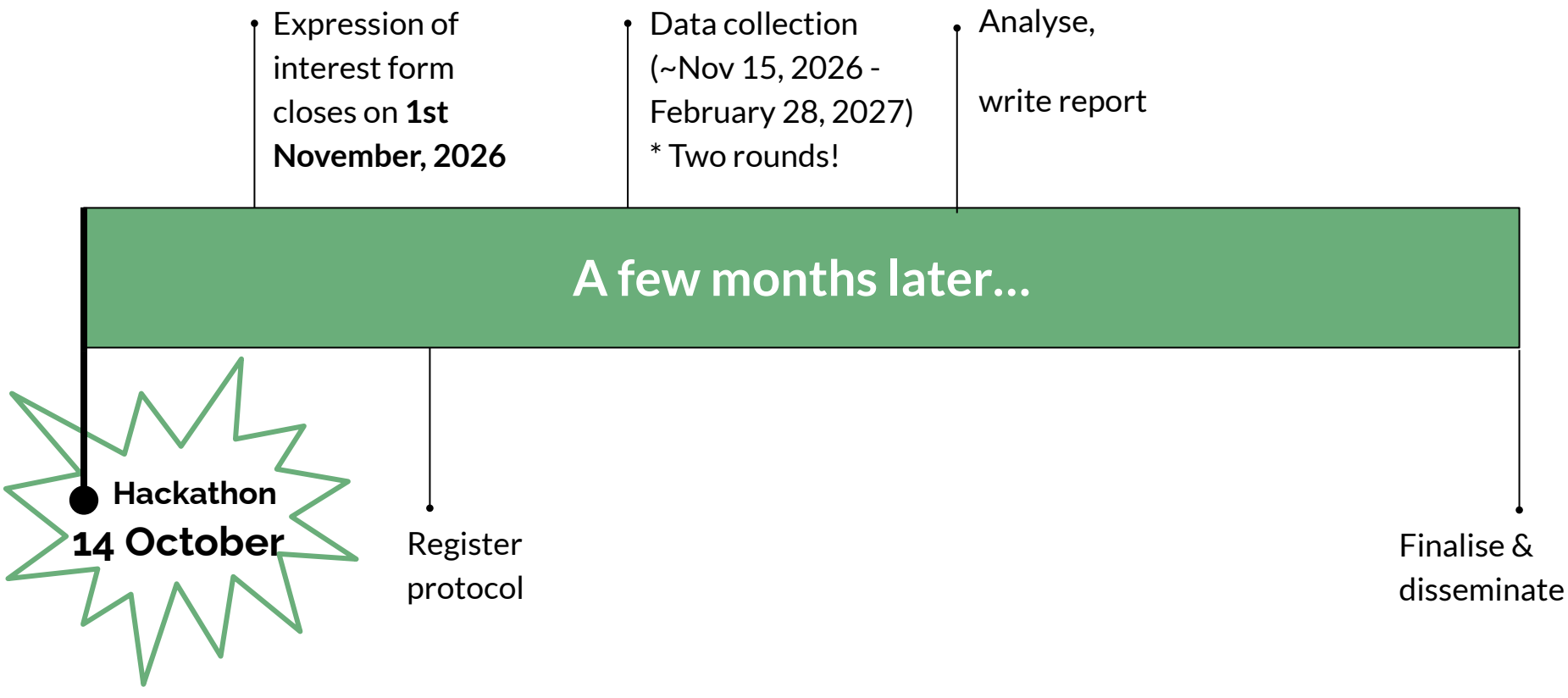


Project Purpose

- ➔ **Follow up study to investigate whether sending a one time prodding email changed societies' publicly available membership fee structures towards greater equity**
- ➔ **Gathering a diverse team, no special skills required**
- ➔ **Collaboration and fun!**
  Working together and driving change!

SORTEE
Society for Open, Reliable, & Transparent
Ecology & Evolutionary Biology

Tentative Project timeline



Protocol - TODAY!

- Anybody can familiarize themselves with the Study Protocol via Google Doc (minor feedback only!)
- Contributorship agreement & Code of Conduct
- Interested in contributing? Please fill out the Expression of interest form after reading the full protocol (https://forms.gle/4gKLuQ1WiT57Bvwt5)

Deadline: Nov 1, 2026

- Let the facilitators know any questions you may have



Chat | Raise hand | Email: Marija (purgarfi@ualberta.ca) & Losia (losialagisz@gmail.com)

What will happen next?



After the hackathon we will:

- Incorporate minor feedback on the Protocol
- Review EOI and send invite for team members
- Register the protocol on OSF
- Collect data and write up something (blog, preprint, article?)